

RANGELAND, NOMADIC KNOWLEDGE & YOUTH

Living Rangelands

One-line value proposition:

An intergenerational field-learning programme connecting young people with rangeland stewardship, seasonal pasture knowledge and Mongolia's living nomadic knowledge.

1. Project Title

Rangeland, Nomadic Knowledge & Youth — Living Rangelands

2. Context / Problem

Mongolia's nomadic way of life is closely connected with livestock, geography, weather, seasonal movement and the condition of pasture.

HWK's existing Nomadic Heritage Experience introduces participants to seasonal movement between winter, spring, summer and autumn camps, decisions around pasture use, regional differences in nomadic practices and conservation knowledge embedded in nomadic culture.

This provides a foundation for a field-learning programme that connects young people with rangeland stewardship through direct learning from landscapes, herder families and relevant specialists.

The concept does not treat traditional knowledge as static or romanticized. It approaches it as practical knowledge shaped by place, season and lived experience.

3. Project Objective

To strengthen young people's understanding of rangeland stewardship by connecting field-based environmental learning with nomadic knowledge and relevant scientific perspectives.

4. Target Group

- Young people and students
- Educators
- Herder families and local knowledge holders participating as learning partners
- Community participants
- Organizations working on land, rangelands, youth or environmental education

Participant numbers and age range: [TO CONFIRM]

5. Proposed Activities

1. **Field learning with participating herder families** focused on nomadic life and the relationship between people, livestock, pasture and seasonal conditions.
2. **Seasonal pasture learning** examining winter, spring, summer and autumn movement and the factors influencing pastoral decisions.
3. **Landscape observation activities** exploring vegetation, pasture condition, weather, geography and land-use relationships at an introductory educational level.
4. **Intergenerational knowledge exchange** between young participants and participating local knowledge holders.
5. **Science + traditional knowledge dialogue**, bringing relevant researchers or specialists into field discussions where appropriate.
6. **Youth documentation and storytelling**, recording learning experiences, observations and knowledge with the agreement and participation of relevant knowledge holders.

6. Expected Outputs

- A structured rangeland and nomadic-knowledge field-learning module.
- Intergenerational field-learning sessions.
- Youth learning activities focused on seasonal movement and land stewardship.
- Documented learning stories and field observations.
- Opportunities for dialogue between herder knowledge holders, young people and relevant specialists.
- A platform for future institutional or research collaboration.

7. Expected Outcomes

The programme is intended to:

- improve young people's understanding of rangelands and seasonal pasture use;
- strengthen awareness of relationships between livestock, land, weather and human decisions;
- create opportunities for respectful intergenerational knowledge exchange;
- increase recognition of practical conservation knowledge within nomadic life;
- strengthen connections between community knowledge and environmental learning;
- create a basis for future collaboration between educators, communities and research partners.

8. Expected Impact

The intended long-term contribution is stronger youth understanding of land stewardship and greater connection between environmental learning and Mongolia's living nomadic knowledge.

The programme can support awareness relevant to land restoration and sustainable rangeland stewardship, but HWK does **not** claim at concept stage that the educational programme itself will restore a quantified area of rangeland or produce measurable ecological recovery.

9. HWK Approach

The concept applies:

Hike → Learn → Experience → Care → Protect

Hike — enter rangeland landscapes and learn from place.

Learn — hear knowledge from herders, local knowledge holders and relevant specialists.

Experience — observe seasonal pasture use, landscape conditions and the realities of nomadic life.

Care — develop respect for land, livelihoods and the knowledge required to live with changing environmental conditions.

Protect — connect learning with responsible land stewardship and restoration awareness.

10. Partnership Opportunity

Partners can contribute through:

- programme funding or sponsorship;
- rangeland and land-stewardship expertise;

- research collaboration;
- training and learning methodology;
- support for intergenerational learning;
- educational resources;
- institutional partnerships;
- community-based field programmes;
- knowledge exchange;
- appropriate documentation or research methods.

HWK would contribute the field-learning platform and educational approach; specialist research or technical land-management components would be co-developed with qualified partners.

11. Funding Need

Funding amount: [TO CONFIRM]

Potential resource categories include:

- programme coordination;
- participation and field-learning logistics;
- transport;
- involvement of participating knowledge holders and relevant specialists;
- educational materials;
- field documentation;
- partner-led technical or research activities.

Detailed funding needs will be developed only after programme scope, communities, locations, duration and partner roles are agreed.

12. Scalability / Replication Potential

HWK source materials note that migration patterns, equipment, customs and practices differ across Mongolia's regions and ecological settings.

For that reason, replication should use a **common learning framework but locally adapted content**.

Potential future versions could work with different youth groups, institutions and rangeland settings, provided that local knowledge holders are directly involved in shaping the learning.

Implementation beyond currently documented settings is **[TO CONFIRM]**.

13. Why HWK

HWK already includes:

- Nomadic Heritage Experience activities;
- field-based environmental learning;
- learning from local knowledge holders;
- youth and community engagement;
- environmental and biodiversity education;
- collaboration with relevant subject specialists.

This makes HWK a relevant platform for connecting young people, landscapes, community knowledge and scientific learning without positioning HWK itself as a rangeland research or restoration institution.

14. Suggested Partner Types

- Rangeland and land-restoration organizations
- Pastoralism and sustainable-land initiatives
- Universities and research institutions
- Youth and education organizations
- Community-development organizations
- Organizations working with traditional or local knowledge
- Environmental foundations and grant-makers
- Corporate / ESG partners focused on land stewardship
- Institutional partners interested in science-community knowledge exchange

Partnership Ask

Partner with Hiking with Knowledge to co-create a youth field-learning programme that connects Mongolia's living rangelands, nomadic knowledge and environmental science for stronger land stewardship.